Inventory · Stack · Structure

cards-stack

Parallel items stacked vertically, full-width cards.

The stack ranks three cards top to bottom.

Order is the argument.

The stack reads as priority; the top card wins.

Three is the sweet spot.

Bodies run a short paragraph at most.

Sixteen words per card.

The budget that keeps rows breathing.

horizontal lays the stack on its side.

Rows become columns.

The ranking now reads left to right.

Same card anatomy.

Title, body, optional status pill.

Use for timelines.

Sequence feels natural sideways.

An ordered list makes the ranking explicit.

1

Numbers stamp the rank

The stack's order stops being implicit.

2

Three still rules

Numbering does not raise the ceiling.

3

Parallel or nothing

Ranked cards must match shapes.

Four rows with pills is the stack's ceiling.

Row one shipped

A body at the hard budget holds two sentences; the pill carries the status so the prose does not have to.

Row two on track

Four bodies this size still fit at body size; `compact` would only close the gaps between rows.

Row three at risk

Keep the densest row third; the eye expects trouble near the bottom and reads it with full attention.

Row four blocked

The hard stop. A fifth row overflows; split the stack or drop to list-tabular.

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When NOT to reach for cards-stack.

Five or more items

Past four the stack overflows. For five or more parallel items reach for cards-grid four, or split across slides.

One-line cards

If each card is a single short phrase, the stack reads as a padded list. Drop to `list` (or its `takeaway` variant) and reclaim the vertical space.

Forced sequence

Cards-stack is parallel content read in vertical order, not a numbered sequence. For explicit steps, use list-steps or `list takeaway numbered`.

Related components

See also.

`cards-grid` — three or four parallel items in a scannable grid

`compare-prose` — exactly two items, side by side

`list-steps` — items carry an explicit, ordered sequence